Subscriptions

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Accessibility

- The internet has brought in a new world of commerce.
- Online shopping rose 50% to $870 Billion in 2021 (Forbes.com)
- Following the classic business models of news outlets, many businesses have turned to Subscription services

Most Popular

- Subscription services are not inherently wrong, some of the top subscription services can save an incalculable amount of money each year within a household
- The most common subscription services are:

  -Netflix

  -Amazon Prime

  -Spotify

  -Disney+

  -HBO and HBO Max

Discussion

- Putting aside the algorithms that choose what tv shows and movies are recommended to you, Do you guys see an issue with the instant gratification of getting to watch what you want, when you want to, compared to waiting until its live?
- Do you think it gets in the way of doing healthier activities such as socializing, exercise, getting outdoors and especially sleep?

Other Subscription services

- BattlBox – Outdoor and Survival gear
- MeUndies – Artistic Underwear
- CatLadyBox – Cat Themed Items

New Subscription Services Going Too Far

- Automotive Manufacturers have started creating subscription services for vehicles. For everything from an app remote start to forcing the car to work.
  - GM Remote Start App: $17/month
  - Toyota Remote Start (Just the fob): $8/month
  - BMW Heated Seat: $18/month
  - BMW Apple Car Play: $15/year
  - Mercedes Acceleration (20-24% more power): $100/month

Discussion

- Should producers be allowed to force the consumer into a subscription when they have already paid for the product?

Video Games

- While for video games as a whole, you do not need a subscription to play the game, many multiplayer games require subscriptions to get online.
- World of Warcraft costs $55 to purchase plus an additional $17 / month to play it.
- Numerous consoles require a subscription to play games online such as:
- Playstation Plus
- Xbox Game Pass
- Nintendo Online

Discussion

- How many of you play video games online? Is it fair to charge a fee to play games with friends?

Subscription to Emails

- Numerous companies trick user into unknowingly subscribing to their newsletters and propaganda.
- The link to unsubscribe is often small and hidden at the bottom, many sites even have confusing questionnaires to continue tricking users into staying subscribed to their emails.

Final Discussion

- Do you see the growing business model of subscriptions to be an issue and where do you see it going?